WHAT WAS I NEVER SUPPOSED TO FIND OUT?

THE PROTECTION PARADOX

A FORENSIC DOCUMENTARY INVESTIGATION INTO THE PAPER TRAIL OF DR RICHARD WILLIAM McLEAN — BARRAN DODGER

Institutional responsibility, public-interest disclosures, administrative fragmentation, disability support, information access, material detriment, digital preservation and the search for accountability

Author and first-person witness: Dr Richard William McLean
Public archive: Barrandodger — primary GitHub evidence repository
Preservation collection: Barrandodger website backup
Original public website: Barrandodger archive
Rebuilt public website: Barrandodger rebuild
Associated documentary research: The Documentary Trap — repository search

Research classification: Public documentary investigation, first-person testimony, administrative chronology reconstruction and evidence preservation.

Central methodological statement: A finding aid, not a court. A documentary argument, not a verdict. An invitation to examine the underlying records, not a demand that readers accept every interpretation without scrutiny.

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PART I — THE DISCOVERY

1. What was I never supposed to find out?

I cannot establish, merely from the existence of a documentary archive, that a particular person intended to prevent me from discovering something. That question of intention requires evidence of its own.

But I can explain what I came to suspect, what prompted the suspicion, how I pursued it, and why I believe the documentary trail deserves examination as a connected body of evidence rather than a collection of unrelated administrative events.

I came to suspect that the cumulative significance of my circumstances could not be understood by looking at one letter, one complaint, one government decision, one

support arrangement or one administrative refusal at a time.

The more I sought to preserve the record, the more important it became to ask how the pieces related to one another. What had I reported? Who had received it? What did the documents actually say? Which issues had been assessed? Which decisions concerned only jurisdiction or procedure? What explanations had been provided? What had happened after those decisions? What questions were still unanswered?

These were not abstract questions. They concerned my life, my independence, my ability to obtain support, my financial circumstances, my attempts to pursue complaints and my understanding of the treatment I had experienced.

I began to distinguish between the existence of an administrative process and the resolution of the issue that had prompted it.

A complaint can be received without every allegation being examined. A referral can take place without establishing that the underlying matter has been resolved. A freedom-of-information decision can release records without determining whether the conduct described in them was proper. A support plan can be approved without necessarily resolving every practical problem affecting a person's life.

Those distinctions became central to my investigation.

The question was no longer simply whether an individual interaction had gone badly. It was whether the full chronology disclosed a pattern of unresolved responsibility, inconsistent explanations, gaps in the documentary record or cumulative detriment that became difficult to see when each administrative event was treated separately.

I came to suspect what I call the protection paradox: the possibility that a person seeking assistance, protection, investigation or review can become caught between separate institutional processes, while the cumulative consequences remain inadequately addressed.

That is the hypothesis I want readers to investigate.

I do not ask readers to infer a coordinated scheme merely because several organisations appear in the same archive. I ask them to examine the evidence, follow the dates, compare the documents, identify the decision-makers and determine what the record supports.

My claim is that the documentary trail matters.

My method is to preserve it.

My purpose is to make it examinable.

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2. The central thesis: the paper trail is not merely background information

The Barrandodger archive is an attempt to preserve the documentary basis of my experiences and make the underlying records accessible.

The distinction between an account and a documentary investigation is important.

An account describes what a person says happened. A documentary investigation identifies the records relevant to that account, reconstructs their sequence, examines their provenance, compares their contents and distinguishes what is expressly documented from what is inferred.

My archive brings together government correspondence, freedom-of-information material, administrative decisions, complaint records, employment-related correspondence, disability-support documents, personal testimony, analytical papers and preserved website material.

These materials have different evidentiary functions.

A contemporaneous letter may establish that a particular concern was communicated on a particular date. A decision may establish that an administrative outcome was recorded and that reasons were given. An information-access schedule may identify documents considered within a request. A later response may clarify, qualify or contradict an earlier explanation. A personal statement may describe the effects of events that administrative correspondence records only partially.

The investigative task is to bring these materials into relationship without confusing their different functions.

The central thesis is therefore:

The significance of my circumstances must be assessed through the chronology and relationships between the records, not solely through isolated institutional responses.

This thesis can be tested.

Readers can ask whether the records support the proposed chronology, whether the named people held the roles attributed to them, whether the documents say what my analysis claims they say, whether there are alternative explanations, and whether the practical consequences can be linked to specific decisions.

The archive's value is that it provides a structure in which these questions can be asked directly.

Primary access: https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger

PART II — THE PEOPLE AND INSTITUTIONS IN THE DOCUMENTARY TRAIL

3. Named individuals: identifying responsibility without substituting a name for proof

An investigation of institutional responsibility must identify the people associated with relevant communications and decisions. It must also distinguish between a person's appearance in correspondence, their administrative role, their authority over a decision and evidence of personal responsibility for a particular outcome.

The following people have been identified in the material discussed in connection with this archive. The exact scope of their involvement must be established from the relevant primary documents.

Dr Richard William McLean — Barran Dodger

Role in the research: Author, first-person witness and compiler of the archive.

My correspondence, complaints, records of requests for assistance and personal testimony form the central subject of the investigation. My account supplies the questions the documentary analysis seeks to answer; the underlying records provide material against which particular statements can be checked.

The relevant questions include what I communicated, when I communicated it, what responses I received, what decisions followed and how the sequence affected my circumstances.

The archive preserves my perspective without requiring that every interpretation be

treated as established fact.

Scott Treadwell — employment-related correspondence

Named documentary lead: Scott Treadwell correspondence dated 8 January 2024

This correspondence has been identified in my archive as relevant to questions about employment status, superannuation and the handling of related administrative matters.

The significance of this document depends on its exact language and context. The investigation must establish what question was being addressed, the capacity in which the correspondence was written, whether it expressed an opinion or a determination, and whether subsequent decision-makers considered it.

A statement relevant to employment status may be important without automatically determining eligibility under a separate statutory scheme.

The research question is whether the correspondence clarifies the employment-related issue or exposes a matter that requires further explanation.

Philip Glass — NSW Trustee & Guardian

Institutional context: Financial administration and decisions affecting practical independence.

My dealings with NSW Trustee & Guardian are relevant to questions about financial decision-making, the consideration of my circumstances and the practical consequences of administrative outcomes.

Named records include:

- **Section 122 document dated 16 October 2024**
- **Vehicle disposal decision dated 14 November 2025**

The documentary questions are what authority was exercised, what reasons were given, which information was considered, how my wishes and circumstances were recorded, and what review mechanisms were available.

Philip Glass's precise role in any individual decision must be established from the relevant correspondence. The fact that a person is associated with an institution does not establish that they personally made every decision taken by that institution.

Julian Lane — Victorian Disability Worker Commission

Identified role: Acting Senior Intake and Response Officer, Victorian Disability Worker Commission, as described in the correspondence previously provided.

The relevant documentary issue concerns the handling of disability-worker concerns, jurisdiction and the question of referral to an appropriate New South Wales counterpart.

The investigation should establish what concerns were submitted, what the Commission said it could address, whether any jurisdictional limitation was identified, whether referral was discussed or completed, and what response followed.

The relevant evidence concerns the recorded handling of the communication, not assumptions about an individual's motives.

Rachael Kerr — identity and agency-related questions

My previous account has raised questions about identifying relevant personnel and establishing who held responsibility for particular actions.

For the documentary investigation, the relevant questions are the person's recorded position, the source establishing that position, the specific communication or decision being examined, and any evidence connecting that action to the issue under investigation.

Any assertion about personal responsibility must be tied to an identifiable act, decision, communication or other evidence.

Suki — support coordination

My account raises concerns about communication, responsiveness and the handling of requests for assistance within a support-coordination arrangement.

The documentary questions include the person's full professional identity, the relevant service agreement, the responsibilities of the role, the dates and contents of requests, the responses recorded and the consequences of any delay or non-response.

A failure to respond to a particular communication, if documented, is different from proving financial misconduct or deliberate harm. Those more serious claims require additional evidence specific to them.

A. Riley — Attorney-General's Department correspondence

Named documentary lead: Attorney-General's Department correspondence dated 19 September 2023, reference MC23-028244, previously identified as signed by A. Riley of the Security Law Section and concerning referral to the Inspector-General of Intelligence and Security and the Commonwealth Ombudsman.

Search for reference MC23-028244

The document is relevant to the question of how concerns were directed between institutions, what purpose the referral was intended to serve, and whether subsequent correspondence recorded an outcome.

A referral does not establish that the underlying allegation was substantiated. Its significance lies in the precise issues referred, the authority of the receiving body and the subsequent documentary trail.

Anthony Albanese and the Prime Minister's Office

My archive history identifies a Prime Minister's Office note dated 12 December 2022, reportedly recording that an email was not forwarded.

Search for Prime Minister's Office correspondence

The original wording must be checked before drawing conclusions about the circumstances or consequences of the communication.

The relevant question is what the office recorded about the handling of the email, what request or concern it concerned, and whether the handling affected subsequent communication or review.

The existence of a note about an email not being forwarded would establish a specific administrative event if verified. It would not, on its own, establish why the event occurred or that it formed part of a wider scheme.

Other officers and decision-makers

The archive contains further correspondence associated with government departments, oversight bodies, disability administration and other institutional processes.

The complete evidence index should identify each person by name, role, document date, reference number and recorded action. Where a name appears only in a copied email or a third-party account, that limitation should be recorded.

The purpose is not to produce a list of people against whom conclusions have already been reached. It is to make the allocation of responsibility traceable.

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PART III — THE EVIDENCE CHRONOLOGY

4. The early administrative record: 2021

26 May 2021 — Comcare and the employee-status question

My archive history identifies a Comcare refusal dated 26 May 2021 that raised the question of employee status under section 5 of the Safety, Rehabilitation and Compensation Act 1988.

Search the repository for the Comcare refusal

This is a significant documentary lead because employee status can be a threshold issue in statutory compensation processes.

The relevant questions are what employment relationship was alleged, which legal definition was applied, what evidence was considered and what reasons were provided.

A refusal based on a statutory eligibility requirement is not the same as a finding that the underlying experience did not occur. Equally, disagreement with an eligibility decision does not establish that the decision was unlawful.

The investigation must examine the actual decision and any later material relevant to the same question.

3 June 2021 — NDIS Quality and Safeguards Commission correspondence

My archive history identifies a letter dated 3 June 2021 concerning the NDIS Quality and Safeguards Commission's position on whether the relevant process made me an employee of that Commission.

Search for the NDIS Commission employment correspondence

This record should be read alongside the Comcare correspondence, but the two should not be treated as though they necessarily answered the same legal question.

The comparison requires the precise wording of both documents, the statutory frameworks involved and the capacity in which each institution was communicating.

The research question is whether the records reveal a genuine inconsistency, different legal tests, different institutional functions or an issue that remains unresolved.

15 November 2021 — Commonwealth Ombudsman complaint

Open the complaint record

This complaint provides an identifiable starting point for examining what concerns I communicated to the Ombudsman and how those concerns were handled.

The investigation should extract the complaint's specific allegations, dates, requested remedies, supporting material and the institution's subsequent responses.

The central question is whether later correspondence addressed the substance of the complaint or only a narrower procedural or jurisdictional issue.

A complaint establishes what the complainant raised. The response establishes what the recipient said or did. A finding about adequacy requires comparing the two.

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5. The information-access and oversight record: 2022

14 July 2022 — OPMC/OAIC-related material

The archive history identifies a document dated 14 July 2022 concerning OPMC and OAIC-related correspondence.

Search for the July 2022 record

The record should be examined for the precise institutions involved, the issue being raised, the relationship between the correspondence and any information-access process, and the claims actually made.

The existence of a document with a title suggesting concealment or a cover-up does not itself prove concealment. The evidentiary value lies in the document's contents and the records that corroborate or contradict its interpretation.

OAIC reference RQ22/00794 — reported Outlook material

My archive history identifies OAIC reference RQ22/00794 and an estimate of approximately 1,187 PM&C Outlook items under review.

Search for OAIC reference RQ22/00794

This is an important lead for examining the relationship between the information requested, the volume of material identified, the scope of any review and the eventual outcome.

The figure of approximately 1,187 items should be treated as a reported archive figure until the original correspondence confirms exactly what it counts. An item count does not establish that every item concerns the same subject, supports the same proposition or contains evidence of wrongdoing.

The relevant questions are what records were within scope, how they were searched and assessed, what was released, and what conclusions can reasonably be drawn from the result.

12 December 2022 — Prime Minister's Office note

Search for the December 2022 correspondence

The note has been described in the archive history as recording that an email was not forwarded.

The exact text should be quoted in the final evidence index, with the date, author, recipient and context. The significance depends on what communication was involved and what consequences, if any, followed.

This is an example of why the wording of a source matters: a narrow statement about the handling of an email should not be expanded into a broader conclusion without additional supporting records.

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6. The disclosure and referral record: 2023

27 March 2023 — Federal Court-related public-interest disclosure assessment

Open the named record

This document has been identified as relevant to the public-interest disclosure history in my archive.

The final poster should quote its exact operative wording and identify the questions it actually addresses. It should distinguish any discussion of statutory definitions or procedural eligibility from findings about the substance of the allegations.

19 September 2023 — Attorney-General's Department reference MC23-028244

Search for MC23-028244

The correspondence has been identified as a referral involving the Inspector-General of Intelligence and Security and the Commonwealth Ombudsman.

The documentary analysis should establish the scope of the referral, the stated purpose, any jurisdictional explanation, and the records showing what happened next.

A referral is evidence of an administrative pathway. It is not proof that the recipient substantiated the concerns or completed an investigation.

The next question is whether the chronology contains an identifiable outcome and whether that outcome addressed the underlying issue.

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7. The employment and financial-administration record: 2024

8 January 2024 — Scott Treadwell correspondence

Search for Scott Treadwell's correspondence

The correspondence is relevant to the employment-related questions discussed earlier in this poster.

The final evidence schedule should identify the precise proposition attributed to the

document, reproduce the relevant passage accurately and link any later decision said to rely on it.

16 October 2024 — NSW Trustee & Guardian section 122 document

Search for the section 122 document

This record should be examined in the context of the statutory authority, decision-making process and practical circumstances to which it relates.

The important questions include what decision or issue was addressed, what reasons were recorded, what material was considered, and whether the document identifies options for review or further action.

8 October 2024 — FOI 2022/045 revised decision and release history

My archive history identifies a revised FOI decision dated 8 October 2024 associated with the release of five documents. The repository also identifies related release and schedule records dated 1 October 2025.

Search for FOI 2022/045

The dates and relationship between the decisions, releases and schedules should be confirmed directly from the PDFs before the chronology is finalised.

The evidentiary value lies in identifying what was requested, what the decision-maker determined, what material was made available and what the released documents reveal about the underlying matter.

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8. The support and administrative record: 2025

6 February 2025 — Attorney-General's Department reference MC25-000321

Search for MC25-000321

The archive history identifies correspondence dated 6 February 2025 addressed to the Victorian Minister for Police.

The primary document should establish the exact sender, recipient, issue referred,

reason for correspondence and any subsequent action. The mere fact of correspondence with a minister does not establish that the minister made or directed a decision.

8 August 2025 — Commonwealth Ombudsman service restriction

My archive history identifies a service-restriction letter dated 8 August 2025.

Search for the August 2025 service-restriction letter

The exact date and relationship between this record and the later service-restriction document dated 20 January 2026 must be verified. They should not be treated as the same document without checking.

The investigation should examine the stated grounds, scope, duration, review arrangements and relationship to earlier correspondence.

14 November 2025 — NSW Trustee & Guardian vehicle disposal decision

Search for the vehicle disposal decision

The record is relevant to a specific decision affecting practical independence.

The evidence should establish what was decided, who made the decision, what reasons were provided, what alternatives were considered and what consequences were documented.

20 November 2025 — NDIS plan approval

Search for the NDIS plan approval

The plan approval should be examined for the supports actually approved, the period covered, the recorded needs and any limitations relevant to the concerns raised elsewhere in the archive.

Approval of a plan is evidence of the outcome recorded in that decision. It does not necessarily establish that every accommodation or support need has been met.

October 2025 — NCAT and public-guardian review

My archive history identifies an NCAT public-guardian review in October 2025.

Search for NCAT and public-guardian records

The exact application, parties, orders and outcome should be established from the relevant records. A review process should not be described as having reached a particular conclusion without examining its decision or orders.

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9. The continuing support and preservation record: 2026

20 January 2026 — accommodation request concerning SIL/SDA

Search for the accommodation request

The request is relevant to the recorded relationship between accommodation needs, disability support and practical independence.

The analysis should identify what accommodation was requested, the evidence provided, the responsible decision-maker, the response and any unresolved practical needs.

20 January 2026 — Commonwealth Ombudsman service restriction record

Search for the service restriction record

The final chronology should distinguish this record from the service-restriction letter identified as dated 8 August 2025, if both documents exist.

Comparing the records may clarify whether the later document extended, restated, reviewed or otherwise related to the earlier administrative action.

October 2026 — public preservation and archive reconstruction

The current archive project includes a preservation copy of the earlier website and a separate rebuilt website.

The preservation materials include a website backup directory containing HTML, PDF, link and index-related materials.

Open the website preservation directory

The archive's README has described the preservation work as based on a 660-page index. The index is a navigational resource: it should not be confused with a finding that every page's claims have been independently verified.

Preserving the material enables future readers to inspect the records even if the original site changes.

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PART IV — THE INSTITUTIONAL QUESTIONS

10. The Commonwealth Ombudsman: complaint handling and the limits of process

The Ombudsman records are relevant because they allow a comparison between what I raised, what the office said it could do and what subsequent correspondence records.

The central research question is not whether an office issued a response. It is whether the response addressed the particular matter raised, whether the scope of the process was explained and whether any remaining issue was directed to an appropriate route.

The evidence should be organised into four parts:

Original complaint: What I reported and what remedy I sought.

Administrative response: What the office said, what it decided and what reasons it gave.

Subsequent communication: Whether further information was supplied, the decision reconsidered or the matter restricted.

Outstanding issue: What the available documents leave unanswered.

A service restriction can materially affect a person's ability to continue communicating with an office. The implications depend on the actual terms of the restriction and any applicable review or alternative communication arrangements.

The restriction itself does not prove retaliation or establish the merits of the underlying allegations. Those questions require evidence beyond the existence of the restriction.

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11. The OAIC and information access: what did the records reveal?

The OAIC-related material and FOI records are relevant to the recovery and interpretation of documentary evidence.

They can help identify which records were requested, what information was held or searched for, which decisions were made about access and whether subsequent releases changed the available evidence.

A large volume of records can be significant because it creates an opportunity to investigate a chronology. But volume alone does not establish the content, relevance or meaning of those records.

The reported figure of approximately 1,187 PM&C Outlook items associated with RQ22/00794 must be verified against the underlying correspondence before being used as a definitive count.

Similarly, the FOI 2022/045 history should be reconstructed from the original request, decision, revised decision, release and schedule.

The research objective is to establish what became available, how the decision changed, what the documents actually show and which questions remain unanswered.

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12. Attorney-General's Department and referrals: where did responsibility go?

The archive identifies two important reference numbers:

- **MC23-028244, dated 19 September 2023.**
- **MC25-000321, dated 6 February 2025.**

Search for both reference numbers

These records should be examined separately before any relationship between them is asserted.

The investigation should identify the recipient, subject matter, stated purpose, any referral and the subsequent record of action.

The important question is whether the documentary trail allows responsibility to be followed from the original concern through to a recorded outcome.

Where a referral is made, the next step is to determine whether the receiving body acknowledged the matter, considered it, declined it, redirected it or issued a substantive response.

Where the outcome cannot be established from the available records, the correct conclusion is that the outcome remains unresolved in the evidence examined.

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13. NSW Trustee & Guardian: decisions, independence and consequences

The financial-administration records should be examined as individual decisions and as part of the wider chronology.

The section 122 document and vehicle disposal decision are not interchangeable. Each has its own legal and factual context.

The section 122 record should be examined for its statutory basis, decision, reasons and relationship to the circumstances presented.

The vehicle disposal decision should be examined for the authority relied upon, the reasons given, the treatment of my wishes and the practical consequences of the decision.

Where correspondence with Philip Glass or another officer is relevant, the source should establish that person's actual role in the specific matter.

The analysis should also distinguish a financial decision from the wider consequences that may follow when transport, accommodation, communication and support are interdependent.

A decision may be lawful yet still produce serious practical consequences. A decision may also be challenged on procedural or substantive grounds. Those questions require examination of the governing authority, the reasons recorded and the evidence available at the time.

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14. Disability support: service coordination, jurisdiction and unmet needs

The disability-support records raise questions about the connection between administrative decisions and practical independence.

The Victorian Disability Worker Commission correspondence associated with Julian Lane, the support-coordination issues involving Suki, the NDIS plan approval and the accommodation request address different functions.

They should not be collapsed into a single allegation.

Instead, the evidence should establish what each person or institution was responsible for, which requests were made, which responses were recorded and whether the issues were referred or resolved.

Where a person says they received no response, the relevant evidence includes the dated communication, proof of sending or receipt where available, any subsequent reply and the service agreement or other document defining the responsibility.

Where a request was referred to another body, the referral and the receiving body's response should be linked.

Where accommodation or other support remained unresolved, the analysis should identify the particular need, the decision-maker, the response and the documented consequences.

The broader research question is whether the administrative system provided a clear and effective route for addressing the concerns raised.

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PART V — THE DOCUMENTARY METHOD

15. How I connected the records

The method is a form of documentary chronology reconstruction.

First, each source must be identified precisely: filename, date, author, recipient, reference number, repository location and, where available, cryptographic hash.

Second, the relevant proposition must be extracted from the source. A title or summary

is not a substitute for the text.

Third, the source must be placed in chronological context. Earlier requests, later responses and related decisions may change the interpretation of an individual document.

Fourth, the records must be compared for consistency. Differences in wording, jurisdiction, statutory basis or factual assumptions must be identified rather than treated automatically as contradictions.

Fifth, responsibility must be attributed accurately. The person who signs a letter, the person who makes a decision and the institution that administers a process may be different.

Sixth, practical consequences must be connected to evidence. Where a decision is said to have affected accommodation, transport, finances or support, the chronology should identify the decision, the resulting change and any corroborating material.

Finally, conclusions must be graded according to the evidence.

A directly recorded event is different from an inference. A repeated statement is not necessarily independent corroboration if later documents merely repeat the original assertion. A digital timestamp may support the existence of a file or its integrity from a particular point in time, but it does not independently verify every claim within the file.

This method enables the archive to support serious questions without overstating what the available material establishes.

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16. Digital preservation and the importance of provenance

The archive's preservation work is relevant because public documents and website pages can change, disappear or become difficult to locate.

The preservation directory includes website-related HTML, PDFs, links and index material.

Website preservation directory

The original and rebuilt websites are available separately:

- Original website
- Rebuilt website

The distinction between preservation and verification is essential.

Preservation seeks to retain a record and make it accessible. Provenance concerns where the record came from and whether its identity can be established. Integrity concerns whether the file has changed. Interpretation concerns what the document means. Verification of an allegation requires assessing the substantive claim against relevant evidence.

These are related but separate tasks.

The archive has also referred to OpenTimestamps and SHA-256 values for particular documents. Where those details are included, the final evidence index should reproduce the exact hash, timestamp, document filename and verification result. A pending Bitcoin confirmation should be described as pending rather than confirmed.

A cryptographic hash can help establish whether a file matches a previously recorded digital fingerprint. A timestamp can support a claim about when a particular digital commitment was made. Neither proves that every statement in the document is true.

This distinction allows digital preservation to strengthen the auditability of the archive without turning technical metadata into a claim it cannot support.

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PART VI — THE FINDINGS AND THE QUESTIONS THAT REMAIN

17. What the documentary record may establish

The strongest conclusions will be those tied to precise records.

The archive may establish that a particular complaint was submitted, that a particular office issued a response, that a specific decision was made, that an information-access process released identified documents, or that different records contain materially different statements.

It may establish that a question was not answered in the correspondence examined. It may also establish that a decision was followed by a documented practical

consequence.

Where multiple independent sources corroborate the same fact, the conclusion can be stated more strongly than where a later document merely repeats an earlier allegation.

The evidence may also reveal that some issues were addressed only procedurally, that responsibility was referred elsewhere or that the documentary record does not disclose an outcome.

Those findings can be significant even without proving a common purpose among the institutions involved.

18. What remains to be established

The following conclusions require evidence beyond the mere existence of correspondence or administrative decisions:

- **That a named person deliberately caused a particular detriment.**
- **That separate institutions coordinated their conduct toward a shared objective.**
- **That a missing record was intentionally concealed.**
- **That a service restriction was imposed for a retaliatory purpose.**
- **That a particular employment-related document establishes a statutory entitlement.**
- **That a specific financial loss was caused by a particular decision.**
- **That the full documentary pattern demonstrates a deliberate scheme rather than a combination of separate administrative decisions, errors or jurisdictional limits.**

These are not reasons to abandon the investigation. They define what the next evidentiary step must establish.

Where a serious allegation is made, the final poster should identify the exact source, quote the relevant passage accurately and explain the connection between the source and the conclusion.

Where the source does not establish the proposition, the poster should say so.

That is how a public evidence archive remains credible while still presenting the seriousness of the allegations and the impact described by the person making them.

PART VII — WHAT I CAME TO BELIEVE I HAD DISCOVERED

19. The significance of the whole chronology

I came to suspect that the most important questions about my circumstances were obscured when each event was treated as a separate administrative episode.

The Comcare correspondence raised employment-status questions. The NDIS Commission correspondence raised a related but not necessarily identical question. The Ombudsman complaint created another documentary pathway. Later information-access processes provided additional records. The Attorney-General's Department correspondence identified referral questions. NSW Trustee & Guardian records concerned financial administration. NDIS and accommodation documents concerned support and independence.

These records do not automatically establish a single cause or a coordinated plan. They do, however, provide a structure in which the relationship between decisions and their consequences can be examined.

The discovery was the importance of connecting the records, testing the chronology and identifying precisely where the documentary trail supports a conclusion and where it stops.

My concern is that the cumulative effects of the events I describe have been serious. My purpose in preserving the evidence is to enable a detailed examination of those effects and the decisions associated with them.

I want readers to be able to inspect the records rather than rely only on my interpretation.

I want named decisions and communications to be traced to their sources.

I want the relationship between procedure and substantive resolution to be examined.

I want the practical consequences of the decisions to be considered in context.

Above all, I want the questions to remain visible.

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PART VIII — PUBLIC INTEREST AND ACCOUNTABILITY

20. Why this documentary investigation matters

The issues raised by the archive extend beyond my personal circumstances.

Accountability systems depend on the ability to trace responsibility, identify the reasons for decisions, access relevant records and obtain a clear explanation of the available routes for review.

Where a matter passes between organisations, the record should make clear what was transferred and what each organisation was asked to address.

Where an institution limits its role, the reasons and scope of that limitation matter.

Where a person seeks access to records, the decision and the material released can affect the ability to reconstruct events.

Where decisions affect accommodation, financial independence or disability support, their practical consequences are part of the broader context in which those decisions are experienced.

A documentary archive cannot replace the functions of every institution whose records it contains. It can make it easier to identify the questions that need answering and to distinguish documented facts from unsupported conclusions.

The Barrandodger archive is an attempt to preserve that possibility.

Its purpose is not to prevent scrutiny of my interpretation. It is to enable scrutiny of the underlying material.

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PART IX — FINAL STATEMENT

What was I never supposed to find out?

I cannot establish another person’s intention simply by pointing to a large archive, a series of refusals or unresolved questions.

What I can establish, through the method described here, is how I came to suspect that the full significance of my circumstances required a connected examination of the documentary trail.

I preserved records. I compared correspondence. I followed dates and references. I identified named people and institutions whose roles required clarification. I examined the distinction between a recorded administrative action and the resolution of the issue that prompted it.

I came to believe that the cumulative consequences of the decisions affecting me deserved examination as a whole.

The question is whether the underlying evidence supports that conclusion, what it establishes about the conduct of particular people or institutions, and what remains unexplained.

The answer must come from the documents themselves, read in context and compared with the surrounding record.

I preserved the paper trail because I wanted the questions to remain open to examination.

The archive is my attempt to make the evidence accessible, retain my first-person account and ensure that individual documents can be understood in their chronological and institutional context.

It is a documentary investigation, not a verdict.

It is a finding aid, not a substitute for examining the evidence.

It is an invitation to trace the records, assess the claims and determine what the available material actually establishes.

EVIDENCE ACCESS AND RESEARCH REGISTER

Main evidence repository: https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger

Preservation directory: https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger/tree/main/barrandodger.com%20website%20backup

Original website: https://wezzo72.github.io/Barrandodger/

Rebuilt website: https://wezzo72.github.io/barrandodger-rebuild/

Search for Comcare records: https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger/search?q=Comcare&type=code

Search for NDIS Commission correspondence: https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger/search?q=NDIS+Commission&type=code

Search for FOI 2022/045: https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger/search?q=FOI_2022_045&type=code

Search for OAIC reference RQ22/00794: https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger/search?q=RQ22%2F00794&type=code

Search for Attorney-General's Department reference MC23-028244: https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger/search?q=MC23-028244&type=code

Search for Attorney-General's Department reference MC25-000321: https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger/search?q=MC25-000321&type=code

Search for Scott Treadwell correspondence: https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger/search?q=Scott+Treadwell&type=code

Search for NSW Trustee & Guardian records: https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger/search?q=NSW+Trustee&type=code

Search for accommodation and SIL/SDA records: https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger/search?q=SIL+SDA&type=code

Evidence status legend

Primary record: An original or issued document whose provenance and contents must be checked.

Recorded administrative action: An action or decision expressly described in a document.

First-person testimony: My account of events and their effects.

Corroborated proposition: A claim supported by multiple relevant sources that independently support the same fact.

Analytical inference: An interpretation drawn from the relationship between documents.

Allegation: A claim requiring assessment against the available evidence.

Unresolved question: A matter for which the available records do not yet provide a complete answer.

Digital integrity evidence: A hash or timestamp that supports a claim about file identity or digital preservation, but does not by itself verify the truth of the file's contents.

Author: Dr Richard William McLean — Barran Dodger

Purpose: Public documentary preservation, academic investigation, first-person testimony and evidence-led accountability.

STAMP & VERIFY
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